

Quarterly operations report · Q2 2026

Line 4 changeovers

Performance, controls and the proposed Q3 roll-out

Operations Excellence · 1 July 2026 · Illustrative data

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Executive findings

The Line 4 pilot reduced average changeover time by **41%** in eight weeks. The evidence supports a staged roll-out, with a separate engineering review for Line 5.

- **Performance:** the weekly average moved from 94 to 55 minutes across eleven changeovers. That returns about seven hours of line time each week.
- **Cause:** moving tool and die preparation before the stop supplied more than half the measured gain. Quick clamps and a gauge on the kit cart removed further delay.
- **Decision:** approve six kit carts and a five-week coached trial on Lines 2 and 3. Hold Line 5 until its cleaning constraint is measured and scoped.

Recommendation

Approve the staged Q3 plan and require a four-week sustain check before expanding it.

1 Baseline and scope

1.1 Operating context

Line 4 changes product about eleven times a week. In January, the average elapsed time from the last good part of one run to the first good part of the next was 94 minutes. The 45-minute target had been missed for three successive months. At that frequency, changeovers consumed roughly 17 hours of scheduled production time each week.

The pilot covered the mechanical changeover, die preparation, first-off quality check and restart. It did not alter the product mix, planned maintenance window or staffing level. The team recorded three complete changeovers on video and then logged every later changeover on a cart card. Weekly averages are based on those records, cross-checked against the line's MES event times.

1.2 Measures

Measure	Baseline	Pilot end	Basis
Average changeover	94 min	55 min	Weekly mean
Changeovers each week	11	11	Eight-week mean
Weekly stopped time	17.2 h	10.1 h	Count × mean
Target time	45 min	45 min	Site standard

Table 1 — Line 4 baseline and pilot-end measures. Rounded values may differ from underlying logs.

Scope note

The result is a single-line pilot. It is evidence for a trial on other lines, not a guaranteed site-wide saving.

2 Method and controls

2.1 Separate internal and external tasks

The team listed each task visible in the three films, assigned an owner and timed it. A task was marked *internal* only if the line had to be stopped. Fetching the next die, preheating it and checking that tools were present were external tasks that had routinely happened after the stop. The revised sequence starts them during the previous run.

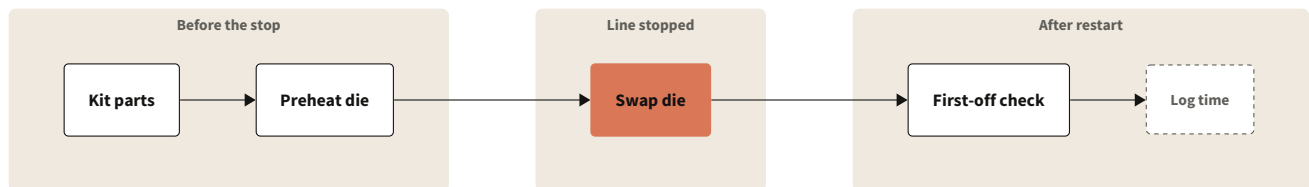


Figure 1 — Revised changeover flow. The highlighted swap is the remaining production stop.

2.2 Control the new sequence

Each product family now has a kit cart with die, clamps, wrench and first-off gauge. The line lead checks the cart before authorising the stop. Operators record the stop and restart times on the card, and the Monday production review flags every changeover above 60 minutes for a short cause review. The written standard is held at the line and is checked at shift handover.

3 Results

3.1 Eight-week trend

Average changeover time fell steadily from 94 to 55 minutes. The largest step followed the introduction of kit carts; later reductions came from quick clamps and placing the first-off gauge at the line. The trend has not yet reached the 45-minute target.

Average changeover time, minutes

Line 4, weekly; dashed line is the 45-minute target

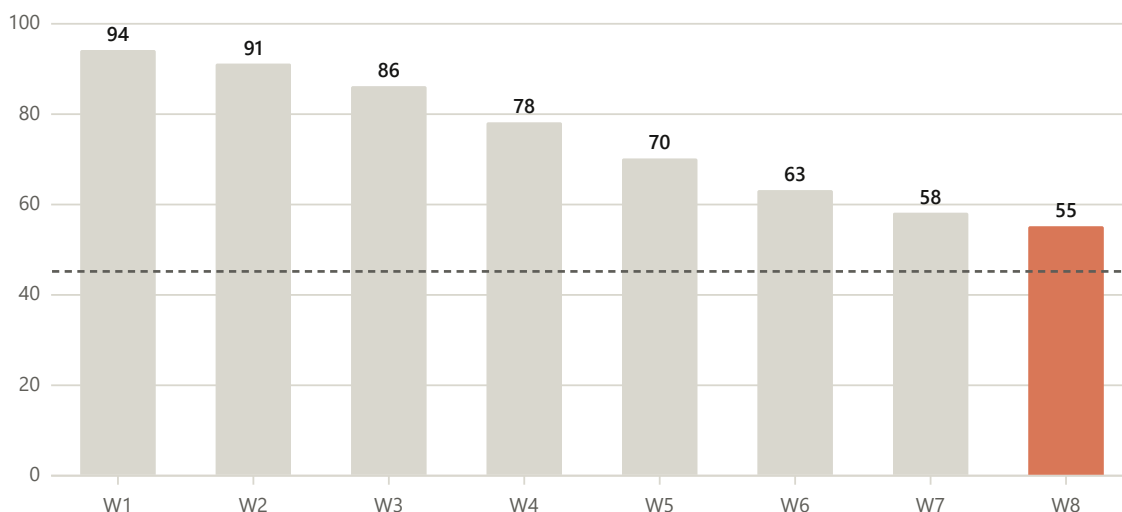


Figure 2 — Weekly average changeover time during the Line 4 pilot. Source: MES and operator cart cards; illustrative data.

3.2 Capacity effect

At eleven changeovers a week, 39 minutes saved per changeover returns about 7.1 hours of line availability. This is available capacity rather than booked financial benefit: output depends on demand, staffing and downstream constraints. The team has therefore reported time saved, with no revenue claim.

The final two pilot weeks remained near 55 minutes. That is an early sustain signal, though a full four-week post-pilot check is still needed before the standard is considered stable.

4 Risks and assurance

4.1 Transfer to other lines

Lines 2 and 3 have comparable die changes but different cart routes. Early trials showed improvement, though less than on Line 4. Line 5's dominant delay is a cleaning step that must occur while stopped, so the same sequencing method is unlikely to deliver the full target there.

Line	Before	Current	Change	Q3 treatment
2	88 min	71 min	–19%	Coached trial
3	102 min	84 min	–18%	Coached trial
4	94 min	55 min	–41%	Sustain audit
5	79 min	81 min	+3%	Cleaning study

Table 2 — Current line comparison. Figures are weekly averages and illustrative.

4.2 Assurance actions

The production manager will review weekly averages and exceptions. Quality will sample first-off checks on each shift. Engineering will verify that quick clamps meet the press specification and assess the Line 5 cleaning requirement. A four-week audit will compare the written sequence with observed practice before any further investment is approved.

Watch item

A faster stop must not trade away first-off quality. Any failed first-off check remains in the changeover time measure.

5 Q3 decision and delivery

5.1 Decision requested

Approve a staged Q3 trial on Lines 2 and 3, funded by six kit carts at an estimated €40,000 installed cost. Assign one lead per line and reserve weekly coaching time from the Line 4 pilot team. Defer a Line 5 equipment decision until the cleaning study reports.

Period	Deliverable	Owner	Check
July weeks 1–2	Film and split tasks	Line leads	Signed task list
July weeks 3–4	Trial carts and sequence	Operations	Daily time cards
August week 1	Publish standards	Engineering	Trained shifts
August weeks 2–5	Sustain and quality audit	Quality	Four-week review

Table 3 — Proposed trial sequence and control points.

5.2 Success criteria

Each line should improve its four-week average by at least 20% with no rise in failed first-off checks. Every shift must use the approved cart and standard. If the trial misses either condition, the team will revise the method before adding more carts. The Q3 steering review will decide whether to scale further.

Appendix · sources and definitions

A.1 Source records

1. Line 4 MES stop and restart events, January–June 2026, weekly export; illustrative sample data.
2. Operator changeover cart cards, eight pilot weeks; illustrative sample data.
3. Three filmed changeovers and workshop task register, pilot week 1; example method record.
4. Q3 kit-cart estimate, Operations Excellence planning assumption; illustrative amount.

A.2 Definitions

Changeover time runs from the last good part before a product change to the first good part after it. **Internal task** requires the line stopped. **External task** can be completed while production runs. **Available capacity** is time returned to the schedule and is not a financial benefit without a production and demand check.

A.3 Reading the figures

Figures and tables use rounded weekly averages. The sample is designed to show report layout and is not a claim about a real facility. Replace every illustrative record with a verified source before issuing a live report.